



resurgent rajasthan

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Soon after coming into power in December 2003, the new Rajasthan Government took stock of development and administration in the state under the far-sighted leadership of Smt. Vasundhara Raje. Given her background in economics and political science, the development of the state was but natural.

A NATIONAL RECORD

The Vasundhara Raje government drew up a Rs.10,000 crores investment programme for the road sector and the administration has spent Rs.7,000 crores in the last four years, with another Rs.3,000 crores slated for next year. As a result, village connectivity rose from 52 per cent in 2003 (against the national average of 60 per cent) to 71 per cent in a period of just four years. It is poised to touch 75 per cent by March 2008. Rajasthan now ranks foremost in the country in the implementation of the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY). The average per kilometre cost, at Rs.15 lakh, is the lowest in the country. The 26,500 kms of roads constructed, and the 8,068 villages connected, are a national record. Rajasthan today, averages a 96 per cent 'Satisfactory' rating as against the national average of 88 per cent. The Government of India (GOI), the World Bank and the media have time and again lauded these achievements.



Rajasthan's vision of 360 degree development is coming true as sound fiscal management and compassionate governance has ushered new competencies in the state to leverage its resources and traditional skills for a sustained growth and secure future.

THE POWER TO EMPOWER

Under the Vasundhara Raje government, the availability of electricity has increased by 15 per cent. This has been made possible by bringing down transmission and distribution losses from the earlier peak of 44 per cent by nearly 6 per cent in one year. This is slated to drop further to 20 per cent. 14,500 villages now get 24-hour power supply while 35,000 villages will be similarly empowered by June 2008. Rajasthan proposes to be self-sufficient in power by the end of 2008.

WATER RELIEF

Rajasthan has just 1 per cent of the nation's water resources. With the participation of six million people, NGOs and government functionaries, more than 1.5 lakh small water harvesting structures have been constructed. Water is also conserved through the promotion of pressure irrigation systems, water harvesting structure, promotion of less water intensive crops and maximizing surface water utilization and expects to achieve upto 80 per cent conservation by the end of this year. Out of 163 ongoing irrigation projects in 2003, 134 have been completed and the rest will be done by March 2008.

AN URBAN AGENDA

Maximizing the opportunities provided by JNNURM, the Rajasthan Urban Infrastructure Finance and Development Corporation is working to support weak local bodies in project development and financing, double entry accounting systems and E-governance and business process re-engineering, Restructuring urban legislation, using spatial data and providing housing for the urban poor also feature prominently in the state's urban agenda. Jaipur is also being developed as a Wi-Fi city.